

PURITY M. OMARIBA

COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-oriented Communications Specialist with over 5 years of experience in media relations, public advocacy, and strategic communication within the development sector. Proven expertise in managing internal, external, and digital communications, translating program needs into impactful projects, creative multimedia content, and well-run content calendars.

Skilled in producing multimedia content, leading web and social media strategy, and balancing creativity with disciplined delivery so communications stay aligned with organizational goals. Adaptable and collaborative, bringing energy and precision to every project through digital tools and storytelling that amplify impact, with a proven ability to craft narratives that inspire action, build trust, protect brand credibility, and resonate with diverse audiences.

KEY SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

- Strategic Communication and Advocacy Planning
- Media Relations and Press Management
- Gender Mainstreaming and Sensitive Messaging
- Web and Social Media Management
- Communication Needs Assessment
- Content Production and Graphic Design Standards
- Stakeholder Engagement and Partnerships
- Monitoring and Evaluation of Communication
- Crisis Communication

WORK EXPERIENCE

Communications and Public Engagement Officer

Jan 2023 – Current

International Solidarity Foundation-Partners | Kisii, Nyamira, Kenya

- Lead communication and public engagement for 2 partner organizations, CECOME and Manga HEART, implementing 6 projects focused on GBV prevention, gender justice, Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights, educational support, livelihood promotion, and civic education.
- Design and execute gender-transformative communication strategies for 6 funded projects, ensuring 100% alignment with advocacy goals and donor visibility guidelines.
- Capture photographs, shoot, edit, and produce documentaries, support podcasts, and create infographics for advocacy campaigns and community projects that strengthen storytelling and audience engagement.
- Oversee digital content management for 12+ social media channels across 2 partner organizations, achieving a sustained engagement growth rate of 15% quarter-on-quarter.
- Facilitate capacity-building workshops for 30+ journalists and influencers per partner organization, equipping them with gender-sensitive reporting skills to amplify project milestones.
- Orchestrate 20+ high-visibility media engagements, including TV interviews, radio talk shows, and Facebook Live sessions, connecting duty bearers with community members to promote policy dialogue.
- Conduct communication needs assessments across 500+ community beneficiaries, translating stories and feedback into proposals and presentations that enhance resource mobilization and donor appeal.
- Design and implement advocacy tools, including advocacy manuals and Terms of Reference (TORs) for digital campaigns, ensuring effective use across programs and stakeholders.

- Curate advocacy messages tailored for diverse audiences and innovate campaigns that communicate behavior change through compelling visuals and infographics.
- Led strategic communication for 30 grantee groups under the EU-funded Financial Support to Third Parties program, coordinating messaging across three cohorts of 10 groups each.
- Featured in the Red Nose Campaign as a storyteller highlighting life without FGM, a narrative that continues to be used internationally for fundraising and advocacy.

Communication and Advocacy Lead

Sept 2021 – Dec 2022

Inuka Success Organization | Kisumu, Garissa, Kenya

- Launched and coordinated 3 major in-country campaigns, increasing public awareness of GBV and anti-FGM issues by over 60% across Kisumu and Garissa Counties.
- Secured media coverage in 10+ local and national outlets by building strong relationships with the press, significantly boosting the visibility of grassroots initiatives.
- Provided training and workshops on communication and advocacy to 25+ staff and volunteers, aligning internal teams with strategic messaging and organizational goals.
- Liaised with county leadership and advocacy partners to ensure newsworthy information reached public decision-makers, contributing to policy discussions on community safety.
- Maintained and updated a database of journalist and influencer contacts, ensuring the organization leveraged these partnerships for consistent public engagement.
- Provided advice and guidance on advocacy messaging to volunteers, resulting in more consistent and impactful public communication.

Communications Assistant

Feb 2020 – Aug 2021

Universal Lighthouse Kenya | Kisumu, Kenya

- Organized 10+ press conferences and media briefings, managing logistics and follow-up communication for successful stakeholder engagement.
- Managed the organization's online presence across 2 digital platforms, resulting in a 40% increase in website traffic and consistent social media engagement.
- Monitored and analyzed media performance, tracking 100+ mentions and preparing analytical reports to inform strategic messaging and public relations.
- Coordinated production and dissemination of 10+ quarterly newsletters, enhancing organizational visibility and consistent information flow to partners.
- Maintained the stakeholder and media database, ensuring timely logistics and attendance for all organizational events and press activities.

ADDITIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

- **Research Assistant** | Pan African Malaria Control Association, Kwale and Busia (Apr 2018 – Dec 2020)

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Communication and Media Studies

Expected 2028

Kisii University, Kisii

Bachelor of Arts, Journalism and Applied Communication

2019

Multimedia University of Kenya

Diploma in Mass Communication

2015

Nairobi Aviation College, Kisumu

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

- Safeguarding Training | Independent Consultant, 2026
- Mental Health and Wellbeing Training | Core Concepts, 2025
- Male Engagement Training | Men Engage Kenya Network, 2025
- Media Advocacy Masterclass | Equality Now, 2024
- Communication, Advocacy and Resource Mobilization Mentorship Session | AMREF Health Africa, 2024
- Budget Advocacy | Uraia Trust / Equality Now, 2024
- Organization Development System Strengthening Training | AMREF Health Africa, 2024
- Legal and Media Advocacy Training | Equality Now, 2024
- Psychological First Aid Training | World YWCA, 2024
- Communication and Storytelling | Equality Now, 2023
- Local Journalists and Social Media Influencers Training | International Solidarity Foundation, 2023–2026
- Media Engagement | White Ribbon Alliance, 2022
- Strategic Communication | GEM Trust Africa, 2022

REFERENCES

Bella Masanya | International Solidarity Foundation +254 705 824 151 | bella.masanya@solidarisuus.fi

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